

BUNKERS AND TUNNELS



▲ CONSTRUCTION

The bunkers were built from pre-cast concrete blocks, carried in from a nearby narrow-gauge railway. Four bunkers and a protected mortar emplacement survive.

► SHELTER

There were 10 two-room bunkers on this site. They were not strong enough to withstand a direct hit from artillery, but did protect their occupants from shrapnel and small-arms fire.



▲ CONFINED SPACES

Headroom within the bunkers was no more than 1.2m (4ft). In part, this was to ensure that troops sheltering inside would never get too comfortable.



▲ TUNNEL ENTRANCE

When conditions allowed, both sides tried to tunnel under the opposing lines, usually in order to explode mines.



▲ ACCESS SHAFT

Vertical shafts gave access to the tunnels. Fierce fighting broke out when opposing tunnellers broke in to each other's workings.